Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 7 ♥ K 3 ♦ Q J 9 8 7 4 2 ♣ 7 6	
♠ 10 9 4 3 ♥ Q J 4 ♦ 10 ♣ Q J 10 9 3		♠ Q J 8 5 ♥ 8 7 6 5 2 ♦ 6 5 ♣ 5 2
	♠ K 6 2 ♥ A 10 9 ♦ A K 3 ♣ A K 8 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5NT[3]
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings

7NT by South
Lead: ♣Q

NORTH isn't sure just how much he can make, but surely 6♦ isn't too much to hope for.

He starts with a Gerber 4♣ and SOUTH shows three Aces.

Hmmm, 5♣ asks for Kings and SOUTH shows three.

Hmm, NORTH can now count all thirteen tricks, so he forgets about the ♦ slam and bids 7NT.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ J 8
♥ J 7 2
♦ 8 5
♣ A K Q 10 9 6

♠ 10 6 5 3
♥ 9 4
♦ A 9 7 6 4 2
♣ 4

♠ 9 7 4 2
♥ A 10 8 5 3
♦ J 10
♣ 3 2

♠ A K Q
♥ K Q 6
♦ K Q 3
♣ J 8 7 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			

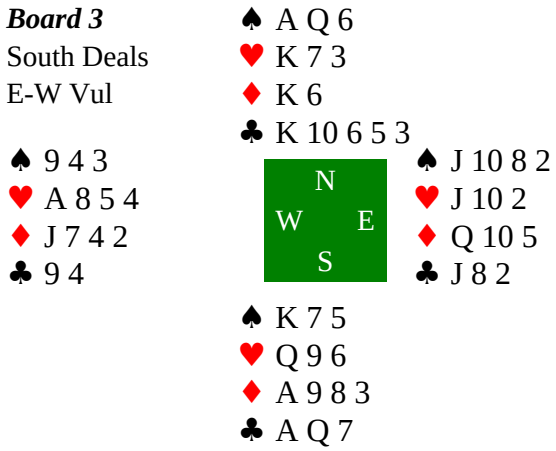
4NT by South
Lead: ♥9

NORTH has 13 points and can contribute six tricks so she figures that twelve tricks will be a slam (dunk).

However, just to make sure the opponents don't take the first two tricks she checks with Gerber.

Uh Oh, missing two Aces she signs off at 4NT. She could also happily play 5♣, but it would be tricky to get there. Very tricky.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			

4NT by South
Lead: ♥4

Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

NORTH has a 16 points and SOUTH has 15, 16 or 17. NORTH wants to be in 6NT if SOUTH has 17, but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT. In this case, SOUTH has but 15 points and declines the invitation. If her ♥Q were changed to the ♥A she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q J 4 ♥ K 6 ♦ K 4 ♣ K Q J 10 5	
♠ 10 5 3 ♥ A 4 3 2 ♦ Q 10 9 2 ♣ 9 3		♠ 9 2 ♥ 10 9 8 5 ♦ 8 7 6 5 ♣ 7 6 4
	♠ A 8 7 6 ♥ Q J 7 ♦ A J 3 ♣ A 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♠5

When SOUTH opens 1NT NORTH hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 9 7 2 ♥ K J 5 3 ♦ K 7 ♣ 7 6 4 2	
♠ Q J 10 6 ♥ 8 2 ♦ 9 5 2 ♣ J 9 8 5		♠ 8 5 4 3 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 10 8 6 4 ♣ Q 10 3
	♠ A K ♥ A Q 10 9 6 ♦ A Q J 3 ♣ A K	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5NT[3]
Pass	6♥[4]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 2 kings

7NT by South
Lead: ♠Q

SOUTH has a pretty good hand, and when NORTH shows ♥ support she naturally thinks about slam.

She has all four Aces but she wants to know about Kings. Unfortunately she can't start at 5NT because that has a different meaning, so she goes through the 4NT sequence even though she already knows the Ace answer.

Finding NORTH with two Kings was what she wanted.

Board 6
North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K 7
♥ K 9
♦ A Q J 10 4
♣ A Q J 7

♠ Q 10 9 5
♥ Q 8 5 3
♦ 9 8 2
♣ 5 4

♠ J 8 4 3
♥ J 7 6 2
♦ 6 3
♣ 10 9 3

♠ A 6 2
♥ A 10 4
♦ K 7 5
♣ K 8 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♠
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

7NT by South
Lead: ♠10

NORTH is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when SOUTH shows 13-15 points NORTH wants to be in a slam.

NORTH cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with SOUTH's latest bid being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in NORTH's hand so he bids 7NT.